

Bitcoiners are adamant that the term blockchain should only be used if it is proof-of-work based. Remember that proof-of-work is a mechanism whereby all the computers building Bitcoin's blockchain remain in sync on how to construct it.

BLOCKCHAIN, NOT BITCOIN

Articles like one from the Bank of England in the third quarter of 2014 argued, “The key innovation of digital currencies is the ‘distributed ledger,’ which allows a payment system to operate in an entirely decentralized way, without intermediaries such as banks.”¹¹ In emphasizing the technology and not the native asset, the Bank of England left an open question whether the native asset was needed.

At the Inside Bitcoins conference in April 2015,¹² many longtime Bitcoiners commented on how many Wall Street suits were in attendance. While Bitcoin was still king, there were growing whispers of “blockchain not bitcoin,” which was heresy to Bitcoiners.

The term *blockchain*, independent of Bitcoin, began to be used more widely in North America in the fall of 2015 when two prominent financial magazines catalyzed awareness of the concept. First, *Bloomberg Markets* published an article titled “Blythe Masters Tells Banks the Blockchain Changes Everything: The banker who helped give the world credit-default swaps wants to upend finance again—this time with the code that powers bitcoin.”¹³ In emphasizing “the code that